

RCF TARGET PAPER 1

Based on the General Certificate of Education (Ord. Level) Examination Model, 2026

ENGLISH LANGUAGE I

Time: One hour

Entered by	Checked by	EMF

Index Number:	Answer ALL questions on this paper itself.
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Test 1

Match the words (a-f) with their correct definitions. Write the correct letter in the box. The first one is done for you.

Photography Equipment

(a) lens	(b) tripod	(c) shutter	(d) aperture	(e) flash	(f) zoom
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(1)A stand with three legs used to keep a camera steady.

(2)A curved piece of glass in a camera that focuses light.

(3)The opening in a camera that controls how much light enters.

(4)A sudden burst of artificial light used in dark places.

(5)The mechanism that opens and closes to let light onto the film or sensor.

(6)A lens feature that makes distant objects appear closer.

Test 2

Fill in the blanks using the words in the box. Write the correct letter in each blank. The first one is done for you.

Speech Excerpt: Malini Fernando on "The Value of Kindness"

(a) compassion	(b) mirror	(c) endless	(d) unfamiliar	(e) sympathy	(f) society
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Speaker: Welcome back! Today we bring you an excerpt from Malini Fernando's speech on kindness.

Malini Fernando: "A kind act works like a (1) b that reflects back on the giver."

Speaker: That's a beautiful way to put it.

Malini Fernando: "Exactly! When we show (2) to a stranger, even someone (3) to us, we make the world a little brighter."

Speaker: It truly changes how people see each other.

Malini Fernando: "Kindness creates (4) possibilities for connection. It builds a caring (5) . Most importantly, it teaches us (6) for those who are suffering."

Test 3

Read the description of the scene and fill in the blanks in the paragraph using the words given in the box. Write the correct letter of the word in the blank. The first one is done for you.

Scene: School Sports Day

It is Sports Day at a school. Students in coloured house shirts are running on a track, while a large crowd sits in the stands, cheering. A teacher is starting a race with a whistle and a flag. Trophies and medals are displayed on a table near the finish line, and colourful bunting is strung above the field.

(a) cheering	(b) track	(c) medals	(d) whistle	(e) bunting	(f) stands	(g) houses	(h) finish	(i) trophies	(j) flag	(k) crowd
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This picture shows students taking part in the annual Sports Day. Runners from different (1) g race along the (2) . A large (3) has gathered in the (4) to watch the events. Meanwhile, the teacher blows a (5) and waves a (6) to start the race. The spectators keep (7) loudly to encourage the runners. Near the (8) line, shining (9) and (10) are displayed on a table,

waiting to be given to the winners. Colourful (11) _____ decorates the field above, adding to the festive mood.

Test 4

Fill in the blanks of the following text about "The History of the Bicycle" using the words given in the box.

it	they	their	this	which	them
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Early bicycles had no pedals, and riders pushed (1) __them__ along with their feet.

Later, inventors added pedals to the front wheel, (2) _____ made cycling much faster.

Many of these early machines had a very large front wheel, and (3) _____ balance was difficult to keep.

Riders often fell off (4) _____ bicycles because the seat was so high above the ground.

Eventually, engineers designed a chain-driven bicycle, and (5) _____ quickly became popular everywhere.

Modern cyclists still enjoy the freedom that (6) _____ simple invention first offered over a century ago.

Test 5

Read the following text and complete the table given below. The first one is done for you.

The Emperor Penguin

The Emperor penguin is the tallest and heaviest of all penguin species, and it is found only in Antarctica. Adults are easily recognised by the bright yellow-orange patches on the sides of their heads. Unlike most birds, Emperor penguins breed during the harsh Antarctic winter, with the male incubating a single egg on his feet for about two months without eating. These birds feed mainly on fish, squid, and krill, which they catch by diving deep into the icy ocean waters. Due to melting sea ice caused by climate change, the Emperor penguin is now classified as a near-threatened species.

(1) Where it is found	Antarctica
(2) Distinctive feature of its head	
(3) Season in which it breeds	
(4) Method used to incubate the egg	
(5) Main foods it eats	
(6) Current conservation status	

Test 6

You are the Secretary of the Nature Club of your school. Write a notice informing Grade 10 students about a Tree Planting Programme organised by your club. Use about 40 - 50 words.

Include the following:

- Purpose of the programme
- Date, time, and venue
- What participants should bring (a small spade)

Test 7

Read the text and underline the most suitable answer for the questions given below.

The Lost Kitten

Nadeeshani found a tiny grey kitten shivering under a parked car on her way home from school. "Poor thing, it must be lost," she said softly, kneeling down to look closer. Her brother Kasun, who was walking with her, frowned and said, "We can't just leave it here, but Mum won't let us keep a pet." Nadeeshani gently lifted the kitten into her school bag lining and wrapped it with her cardigan. "We'll ask the vet down the road if anyone has reported a missing kitten," she suggested. At the clinic, the vet checked a small chip under the kitten's skin and smiled. "This little one belongs to the Perera family two streets away," she said. Nadeeshani and Kasun happily carried the kitten home to its relieved owners that same evening.

(1) Where did Nadeeshani find the kitten?

(a) Inside her school bag (b) Under a parked car (c) At the vet's clinic

(2) Why was Kasun worried at first?

(a) He was afraid of cats (b) Their mother would not allow a pet (c) The kitten looked sick

(3) How did Nadeeshani carry the kitten?

(a) In her arms (b) In a basket (c) Wrapped in her cardigan inside her bag

(4) How did the vet identify the kitten's owner?

(a) By asking neighbours (b) By checking a chip under its skin (c) By reading a collar tag

(5) The word "relieved" in the text means

(a) worried (b) no longer anxious (c) extremely angry

Test 8

Write a paragraph on any **one** of the following topics. Use about 50 - 60 words.

(a) The importance of trees (b) My favourite teacher

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RCF TARGET PAPER 1

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ENGLISH LANGUAGE II

Time: Two hours

Paper II has 8 pages on two sheets.

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Test 9

Read the text and underline the most suitable word given within each bracket.

Bees and Pollination

Bees are among the most important (1) ((a) predators, (b) pollinators, (c) parasites) in the natural world. As a bee moves from flower to flower collecting nectar, tiny grains of pollen (2) ((a) stick, (b) melt, (c) disappear) to its legs and body. When the bee visits the next flower, some of this pollen (3) ((a) escapes, (b) rubs off, (c) evaporates), allowing the plant to produce seeds and fruit. Without this process, many crops that we depend on for food would (4) ((a) flourish, (b) fail, (c) multiply). Sadly, the use of certain pesticides has caused a sharp (5) ((a) increase, (b) decline, (c) improvement) in bee populations worldwide, worrying scientists and farmers alike.

Test 10

Complete the following passage using the most suitable form of the verbs given within the brackets. (A Camping Trip)

Last weekend, my family and I (1) _____ (go) camping near a small lake.

While we (2) _____ (set up) the tent, my father (3) _____ (start) collecting firewood.

By the time it grew dark, we (4) _____ (finish) preparing our meal.

As we (5) _____ (sit) around the fire, we suddenly heard an owl hooting nearby.

Test 11

Fill in the blanks of the following passage with the words given in the box. There is one extra word.

The Great Barrier Reef

reef	coral	marine	colourful	fragile
tourists	snorkelling	damage	protect	unique
ecosystem	species	ocean	ancient	ruins

The Great Barrier (1) _____ off the coast of Australia is the largest living structure on Earth. It is made up of thousands of tiny (2) _____ polyps that build hard, (3) _____ skeletons over thousands of years. The reef supports an incredible variety of (4) _____ life, including fish, turtles, and sharks. Every year, thousands of (5) _____ travel from around the world to go (6) _____ among its (7) _____ underwater gardens. However, the reef is extremely (8) _____, and rising (9) _____ temperatures have caused serious (10) _____ to large sections of coral. Scientists warn that if we do not act to (11) _____ this (12) _____ (13) _____, many marine (14) _____ could disappear forever.

Test 12

Complete the following passage using the most suitable form of the verbs given within the brackets. (Predictions for the New Stadium)

By next year, the new sports stadium (1) _____ (complete) by the construction company.

All the seating (2) _____ (install) before the opening ceremony.

The running track (3) _____ (cover) with a special rubber surface.

Floodlights (4) _____ (fit) around the entire field for night matches.

So far, more than five hundred tickets (5) _____ (sell) for the opening match.

Test 13

Read the following extracts from school "Do's and Don'ts" board instructions and match them with the locations given below. Write the relevant letter of the location in the box against each instruction. There is one extra location.

A	B	C	D	E	F
Music Room	Art Room	Playground	Language Lab	Auditorium	Cafeteria

- (a) Keep instruments and equipment in their proper stands after use. Do not tune instruments loudly during other lessons. ☐
- (b) Wash your brushes properly before leaving. Do not leave paint stains on the tables or floor. ☐
- (c) Wear proper sports attire before entering. Return all equipment to the store after practice. ☐
- (d) Use headphones only when instructed. Do not damage the microphones or switch off computers abruptly. ☐

Test 14

Write on **only one** of the following. Use the space provided.

(a)

As the Secretary of the Environment Club of your school, write a formal letter to the Divisional Forest Officer requesting saplings for a school greening project. Use about 100 words.

Include the following:

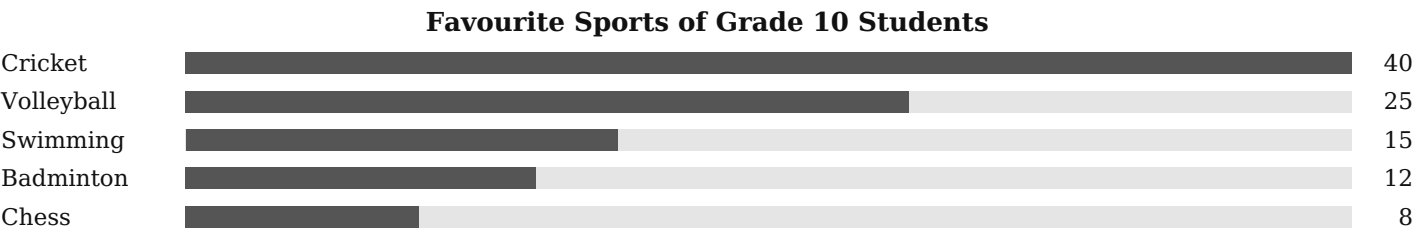
- Explain the purpose of the project
- Request a specific number of saplings
- Mention the expected number of students who will take part
- Propose a suitable date for collecting the saplings
- Request advice on caring for the saplings

OR

(b)

The bar chart below shows the results of a survey done by 100 students on their favourite sports. Write a description about the students' preferences based on the bar chart. Use about 100 words.

Helpful words: many / some / a few / most / more than / less than





Test 15

Read the following text and answer the questions given below.

The Wright Brothers and the First Flight

In the early years of the twentieth century, most people believed that human flight was impossible. Orville and Wilbur Wright, two brothers who ran a small bicycle shop in Ohio, disagreed. They spent years studying birds, testing gliders, and building their own small engine.

On 17th December 1903, at Kitty Hawk, North Carolina, the brothers achieved what many had thought could never be done. Their aircraft, the Wright Flyer, stayed airborne for just twelve seconds during its first flight, covering a distance shorter than the wingspan of a modern jumbo jet. Despite its brevity, the flight proved that a heavier-than-air machine could fly under its own power.

News of the achievement spread slowly at first, as many newspapers doubted the brothers' claims. However, the Wrights continued to improve their designs, and within a few years, aircraft could stay in the air for over an hour. Aviation historians consider that first short flight to be the true beginning of the modern age of air travel.

(1) State whether the following statements are True or False. Put a tick (✓) in the relevant cage.

Statement	True	False
The Wright brothers ran a small bicycle shop before building aircraft.		
Their first flight lasted for over an hour.		
Newspapers immediately believed and celebrated the brothers' achievement.		
The first flight is considered the beginning of the modern age of air travel.		

Underline the correct answer.

(2) The main factor that helped the Wright brothers succeed was

(a) luck alone (b) years of study and testing (c) government funding

(3) Why did news of the achievement spread slowly?

(a) The brothers kept it secret (b) Many newspapers doubted their claims (c) There were no newspapers at the time

(4) What does the word 'its' in paragraph 2 (line 2) refer to?

Answer:

(5) Underline the phrase/word that is closest in meaning to the following:

(a) 'brevity'

(a) shortness (b) great length (c) loud noise

(b) 'airborne'

(a) on the ground (b) in the air (c) under water

Test 16

Write on **one** of the following topics. Use about 200 words.

(a) Write an article to a school magazine on 'The Benefits of Reading for Pleasure'.

Include the following:

- How reading for pleasure differs from academic reading.
- Benefits to vocabulary, imagination, and concentration.
- How students can build a regular reading habit.
- Encouraging classmates to visit the library more often.

(b) Write an essay on 'The Importance of Protecting Wildlife'.

Include the following:

- Reasons why many wild species are under threat today.
- The role wildlife plays in keeping ecosystems balanced.
- Steps individuals and governments can take to protect animals.
- The consequences of failing to act now.

(c) Imagine you are giving a speech at your school assembly on 'The Advantages and Disadvantages of Digital Devices for Students'. Write your speech.

Include the following:

- Formal address to the Principal, teachers, and fellow students.
- Positive uses of digital devices for learning and communication.
- Negative effects such as distraction and reduced physical activity.
- Advice on using digital devices responsibly.

(d) Complete the following dialogue between Ishara and Dinithi about a school trip.

Ishara: Hi Dinithi! I heard our class trip to the museum is next week, isn't it?

Dinithi: Yes, Ishara! I'm really looking forward to it.

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*** End of Paper ***